

Devils Rap Miners Twice

By MARK LEIBSON

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Arizona State has a way of making opponents look silly on the baseball diamond — especially Saturday when the Sun Devils ran over the University of Texas at El Paso in both ends of a doubleheader.

The Miners failed to come up with a pitcher that could stop ASU's bats from ripping the cover off the ball as the Sun Devils took both of the Western Athletic Conference games 15-3 and 12-6 at Dudley Field.

"See what pitching can do to a team?" said Miner coach Andy Cohen. "We couldn't stop them but they had some pitchers who did a fine job."

Injuries plagued the Miners somewhat. Regular second baseman Art Bravo was sidelined with a pulled hamstring and shortstop Danny McMahon was spiked in the first game and sat out the second game.

Their absences proved costly, especially in the nightcap when Orlando Cordova misplayed a two-out, bases-loaded grounder which eventually led to five unearned Arizona State runs. UTEP also allowed five unearned runs in the opener.

"We'll be back," said Cohen. "We need to get our injured players back in the lineup."

Switch-hitting Chris Bando, a spitting image of his major league brother Sal, rapped a pair of two-run doubles off the center field wall in the first game while teammate Steve Michael scored four runs and knocked home two with his first of two homers for the day, never allowing the Miners a chance at staying in the game.

Miner left fielder Danny Haygood was the only batter to produce runs, scoring Dan Feagler and Jerry Walker with a fourth inning single and again sending Feagler home in the sixth with a double to center.

Starting UTEP hurler Jim Sacco took the loss, his third against three wins. Tom Van Der Meersche, who walked five and gave up nine hits, went the seven inning distance for ASU while improving his record to 5-0.

UTEP matched ASU with a single run in the first

inning of game two. Michael slammed a one-out homer far over the fence in right before UTEP's Walker doubled to left, scoring Bob Alsop who had singled and moved to second on a fielder's choice.

Arizona State scored five runs in the next four frames to UTEP's two. Then the roof caved in on the Miners. With the bases loaded and two outs, Greg Stahl hit a hard roller to Cordova at short. Cordova never got his body in front of the ball and it bounded off his glove for a two-run error.

Before UTEP reliever K.C. Nix could force designated hitter Glenn Moon to line to Walker at first, three other unearned runs scored.

The Miners added single runs in three of the final four innings, including Walker's third homer of the year in the ninth to make the score somewhat respectable.

UTEP has now lost five games in a row, the longest losing streak of the season for the 21-13 Miners who are now 0-3 in conference play. ASU is at the opposite end of the WAC standings with a 3-0 record and a 31-8 overall record.

UTEP's next action is Tuesday in Las Cruces against New Mexico State. The Aggies began the Miners' current losing streak by sweeping a doubleheader from UTEP last week.

First Game				Second Game			
ASU	ab r h bi	UTEP	ab r h bi	ASU	ab r h bi	UTEP	ab r h bi
Brooks ss	3 1 2 2	McMahon ss	3 0 0 0	Brooks ss	6 1 1 0	Aragon 2b	2 1 0 0
Michael rf	4 4 2 2	Roberts ph	1 0 0 0	Michael lf	5 2 3 1	Flores ph	1 0 0 0
Allen 2b	3 3 1 0	Cordova 2b	4 0 1 0	Allen 2b	4 0 1 0	Cramer 2b	1 0 1 0
Bando 3b	3 3 2 4	Alsop cf	3 0 0 0	Bando 3b	4 3 1 0	Cordova ss	4 1 2 0
Hudgens 1b	5 0 2 2	Feagler dh	3 2 2 0	Stahl rf	6 3 3 0	Alsop cf p	4 2 1 0
Stahl dh	5 0 1 1	Walker 1b	3 1 1 0	Hudgens 3b	4 1 1 2	Feagler dh	4 0 1 2
Eiler c	3 0 0 0	Haygood lf	3 0 2 3	Irvine cf	4 1 3 3	A. Flores cf	1 0 0 0
Irvine cf	5 3 2 2	Hildebrand c	3 0 1 0	D. Eiler c	5 1 3 1	Walker 1b	5 1 3 3
Moon lf	5 1 2 1	Perez rf	1 0 0 0	Buckner dh	2 0 2 1	Hildebrand c	4 1 1 0
Totals	36 15 14 15	A. Flores rf	2 0 1 0	Moon dh	3 0 0 0	Perez rf	4 0 0 0
		Cramer 3b	2 0 1 0	Totals	38 12 18 9	Bradford 3b	4 0 2 0
		Totals	28 3 9 3			Haygood lf	4 0 1 1
						Totals	38 6 12 6
ASU.....	33 1 330 2-15			ASU.....	121 025 010-12		
UTEP.....	000 201 0-3			UTEP.....	100 021 101-6		
E—McMahon 2, Bando, Cramer, DP UTEP				E—Cordova, DP ASU 1, LOB ASU 12, UTEP			
1, ASU, LOB ASU 9, UTEP 6, 2B Bando 2,				10, 2B—Irvine, Eiler, Allen, Stahl 2, Feagler,			
Moon, Allen, Walker, Feagler, Haygood,				Walker, Cramer, HR Michael (7), Walker (3),			
HR—Michael (6) SB Michael, SF—Brooks,				SB—Irvine, SF—Hudgens, Irvine.			
				Eiler	4 3 1 1 0 1		
				Hawk (W, 2-1)	5 1 5 4 4 2 3		
				Lindsey	3 4 1 1 1 2		
				ip h r er bb so			
				Van Der Meersche (W, 5-10)	7 9 3 3 1 5		
				Sacco (L, 3-3)	1 3 5 4 6 3 1		
				Zotz	2 2 5 7 7 2 0		
				Cartier	2 2 5 3 2 0 2 3		
				HBP—Eiler (By Cartier), WP—Sacco, Zotz			
				Hawk (L, 3-1)	4 10 6 6 2 2		
				Alsop	4 8 6 1 2 1		
				x—faced two batters in fifth,	1 0 0 0 2 2		
				HBP—Aragon (By Hawk), Cordova (By			
				Hawk), WP—Bortell, PB—Hildebrand.			